

Participant Instructions

Welcome to the experiment

Thank you for participating. In this task, you will **steer a spaceship** through an asteroid field. Your goal is to reach the **bottom of the environment** without crashing into any obstacles.

Controls

- The spaceship **falls automatically** from top to bottom.
- You can move it **left** and **right** using two keys:
 - **Y** → move **left**
 - **M** → move **right**
 - (QWERTZ keyboard layout – the keys are labelled)

You cannot change the falling speed. Only horizontal movement is under your control.

Goal

- Avoid **all obstacles** (blue/grey comets).
- Reach the **green line** at the bottom of the level.
- If you crash, the trial will end and you will be able to try again later.

Eye tracking

- Your **eye movements** will be recorded throughout the game.
- Before the experiment starts, we will calibrate the eye tracker. Please **follow the moving dot** on the screen with your eyes – do not move your head.
- Keep your head **resting on the chinrest** during each trial. You may lean back between trials.

Procedure

1. **Calibration** – You will see a dot moving to different positions on the screen. Look at each dot until it disappears.
2. **Start screen** – Press **SPACE** when you are ready to begin the experiment.
3. **Trials** – You will play **30 short levels * 3 times = 90 trials** (each lasting about 40 to 50 seconds). Between levels, you will see a short break screen. Press **SPACE** when you are ready for the next level.
4. If you crash, the same level may be repeated up to **three times**.
5. **After each level** (whether you succeed or crash), you will be asked a brief question about your sense of control (on a scale from 1 to 7). Use the number keys 1 ... 7 to answer.

Important notes

- Stay focused on the screen and keep your head still during each level.
- Try to avoid blinking while the calibration dot is moving.
- If you need to take a longer break (e.g., rest your eyes), do it **between levels**.
- The experiment takes about **45–60 minutes**. There is no time limit per level.